

TOPIC 2: THE BIRTH OF JESUS

1. Biblical Accounts

Matthew 1:18–25: Mary was found to be with child by the Holy Spirit. Joseph planned to divorce her quietly, but an angel appeared in a dream and told him to take Mary as his wife because the child was from the Holy Spirit. Joseph obeyed and named the child Jesus.

Luke 2:1–7: A census ordered by Caesar Augustus required Joseph and Mary to go to Bethlehem. While they were there, Mary gave birth to her firstborn son, wrapped Him in swaddling cloths and laid Him in a manger, because there was no place for them in the inn.

2. Significance

- Jesus was born in humble circumstances (manger), showing that God identifies with the lowly.
- Fulfilment of prophecy that the Messiah would be born in Bethlehem (Micah 5:2).
- Joseph's obedience protected Mary and the child.
- The name Jesus means "the Lord saves."

3. Lessons

Humility, obedience to God, trust in difficult situations, and the truth that God can use ordinary places and people for His greatest purposes.

4. Summary

Jesus was born in Bethlehem to Mary and Joseph under humble conditions. His birth fulfils prophecy and reveals God's plan of salvation.

End of Topic 2